

Computer Programming In QBasic

SYNTAX:

Let <Variable> = < Constant / Variable or Expression >

e.g.

Let A = 15..... Assigning constant to a variable

Let A = B.....Assigning variable to a variable

Let C = A + B.... Assigning an expression to a variable

Using Let with Numeric Variables:

Let A = 50, here **A** is a Numeric Variable and '50' is a Numeric Constant and value '50' is assigned to A and stored in the computer's memory for further calculations.

Using Let with Alphanumeric Variable:

Let N\$ = "QBasic Program", here N\$ is an Alphanumeric Variable and "QBasic Program" is the Alphanumeric Constant assigned to N\$.

NOTE: A numeric data should be assigned to a Numeric variable and an alphanumeric data to an alphanumeric variable otherwise "TYPE MISMATCH" error is displayed.

keywords

i. **END:** This command is usually given at the end of the program. Statements written after end are not executed since the program terminates execution on reading this command.

ii. **INPUT:** This statement allows the user to enter a value for the variable while running the program. A question mark (?) appears on the output screen waiting for the user to enter a relevant data and then press enter key. Once the Return key or Enter key is pressed the data is stored in the variable.

SYNTAX :

INPUT < VARIABLE >

e.g.

Input A.....Enter Numeric constant

Input N\$.....Enter Alphanumeric constant

Input "Enter name: ";N\$....Giving relevant message to avoid erroneous data input

QBASIC REMINDER

A QBASIC program consists of lines containing

1. A line number
2. A QBASIC keyword like PRINT,END etc
3. Each program line begins with positive number.
4. No two lines should have same number.

Chapter I - QBasic Commands

When you open QBasic, you see a blue screen where you can type your program. Let's begin with the QBasic commands that are important in any program.

iii. PRINT

Command PRINT displays text or numbers on the screen.

The program line looks like this:

PRINT "My name is Nick."

Type the bolded text into QBasic and press F5 to run the program. On the screen you'll see

My name is Nick.

Note: you must put the text in quotes, like this – "text".

The text in quotes is called a string.

If you put the PRINT alone, without any text, it will just put an empty line.

PRINT can also put numbers on the screen.

PRINT 57 will show the number **57**. This command is useful for displaying the result of mathematical calculations. But for calculations, as well as for other things in the program, you need to use variables.

Illustration

```
1 CLS      ' this command clears the screen, so it's
empty
  INPUT "Enter the first number "; a
  INPUT "Enter the second number "; b
  IF b = 0 THEN      ' checks if the second number is
zero, because you can't divide by zero
    PRINT "the second number cannot be 0. Try again."
    DO: LOOP WHILE INKEY$ = "" ' waits for you to
press a key to continue
    GOTO 1 then sends you back to line 1
  END IF
END
```

Note: Do NOT use the Close box to close the editor. You should always go to *FILE* then *EXIT*. If the editor is not closed correctly or if you have not saved your file, you could loose all your data.